



▲ L7A2 LIGHT MACHINE-GUN

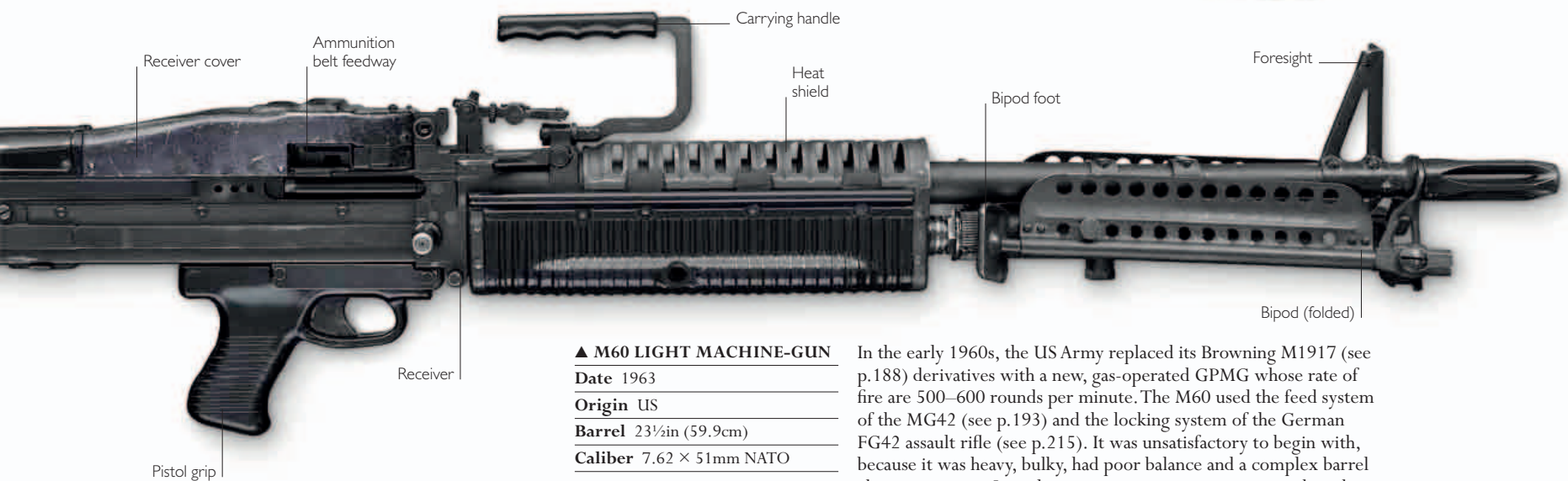
Date 1960

Origin UK

Barrel 27½in (70cm)

Caliber 7.62 × 51mm NATO

The British L7A2 light machine-gun is essentially a copy of the Belgian FN MAG (far left) made under license in Britain. It is a platoon support weapon of considerable versatility since it can also be used with fixed mounts on vehicles.



▲ M60 LIGHT MACHINE-GUN

Date 1963

Origin US

Barrel 23½in (59.9cm)

Caliber 7.62 × 51mm NATO

In the early 1960s, the US Army replaced its Browning M1917 (see p.188) derivatives with a new, gas-operated GPMG whose rate of fire are 500–600 rounds per minute. The M60 used the feed system of the MG42 (see p.193) and the locking system of the German FG42 assault rifle (see p.215). It was unsatisfactory to begin with, because it was heavy, bulky, had poor balance and a complex barrel changing system. In early versions, some components, such as the bolt, experienced failure due to wear. Modifications were carried out over the next two decades to correct most of the gun's faults.



▲ MAUSER-CETME LMG

Date 1960s

Origin Spain/Germany

Barrel 23¼in (59cm)

Caliber 7.62 × 51mm NATO

The Mauser–CETME light machine-gun was a joint German-Spanish development of the German MG42, although chambered for the 7.62 × 51mm NATO round. The gun was not a success with this chambering, because the fluted chamber caused spent cartridge cases to stick—in some instances, the extractor would pull the base of a spent case off its body—a major problem in the field. CETME later achieved a good workable design in their 5.56 × 45mm NATO Ameli machine-gun.